

IT PROFESSIONAL PORTFOLIO

Cloud Engineering and Security Projects

PROJECT 19

Button Up AWS Organizations with Alternate Contacts and Workload OUs

AWS Organizations | Account Management | Workloads OUs | SCPs

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ENVIRONMENT	Personal AWS Lab
VERSION	v1.0.0
RELEASE DATE	July 14, 2026
STATUS	Complete

Executive Summary

Enabled trusted access for AWS Account Management, configured alternate contacts for **Billing**, **Operations**, and **Security** on the management account, expanded the Workloads hierarchy with **Prod** and **Non-Prod** OUs, created **TestAccount1**, moved it into the **Non-Prod** OU, and attached the **ProtectRootAndOrg** Service Control Policy to the **Workloads** OU.

Business Problem

AWS organizations need reliable contact routing and workload boundaries before real application accounts are introduced. Alternate contacts ensure AWS billing, operational, and security communications are routed to the right owners. Prod and Non-Prod OUs create policy boundaries for future workloads, and a test account provides a safe place to validate non-production controls.

Objectives

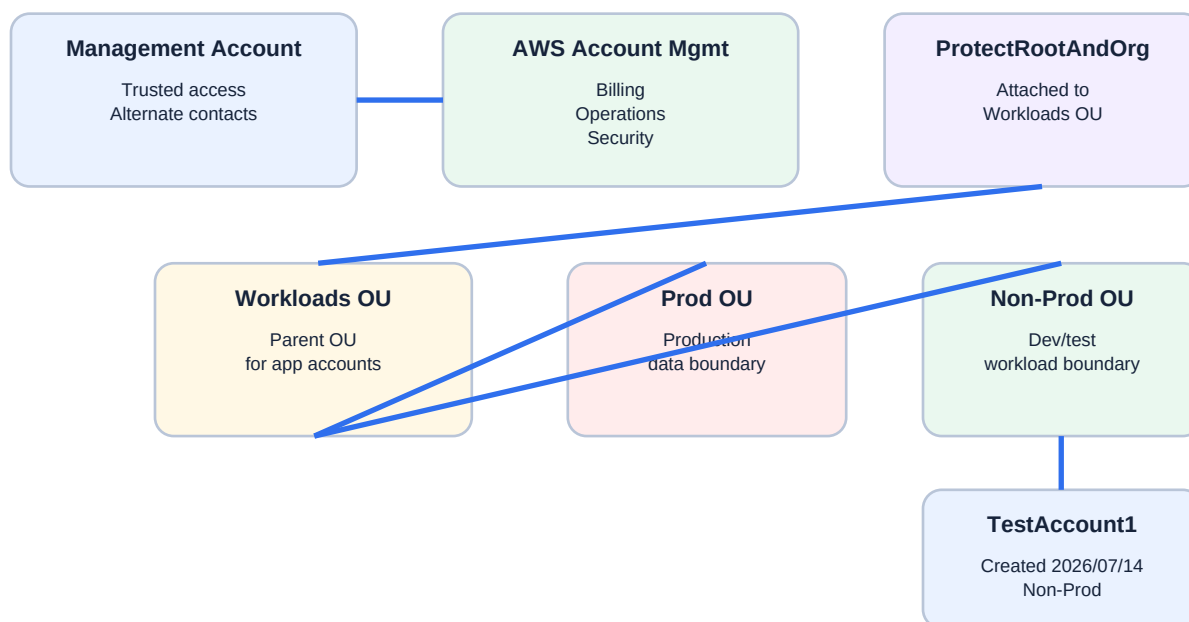
- Enable trusted access for AWS Account Management through AWS Organizations.
- Set management-account alternate contacts for Billing, Operations, and Security.
- Create workload sub-OUs for Prod and Non-Prod under Workloads.
- Create TestAccount1 as an initial workload account.
- Move TestAccount1 into the Non-Prod OU.
- Attach ProtectRootAndOrg to the Workloads OU so workload accounts inherit the root-protection guardrail.
- Document evidence limitations where the provided screenshots do not show every configuration step.

Environment

Cloud Provider	Amazon Web Services (AWS)
Primary Services	AWS Organizations, AWS Account Management, IAM Identity Center
Management Account Change	Alternate contacts set for Billing, Operations, and Security
Trusted Access	AWS Account Management trusted access enabled
Workload Parent OU	Workloads
Workload Child OUs	Prod and Non-Prod
New Workload Account	TestAccount1
Test Account Placement	Non-Prod OU
SCP Attachment	ProtectRootAndOrg attached to Workloads OU

Purpose	Contact routing, workload segmentation, non-production account foundation, and inherited root protection

Architecture



The lab adds contact routing, workload hierarchy, a Non-Prod test account, and workload-level root guardrails.

Figure 1 - Alternate contact routing, Workloads OU hierarchy, TestAccount1 placement, and Workloads-level SCP attachment.

Implementation Summary

1. Signed into the IAM Identity Center access portal and selected AdministratorAccess for the management account.
2. Opened AWS Organizations and enabled trusted access for AWS Account Management.
3. Opened the management account contact information settings.
4. Configured alternate Billing contact information.
5. Configured alternate Operations contact information.
6. Configured alternate Security contact information.
7. Opened the Workloads OU in AWS Organizations.
8. Created Prod and Non-Prod OUs under Workloads.
9. Created TestAccount1 as a new AWS account.
10. Moved TestAccount1 into the Non-Prod OU.

11. Attached the ProtectRootAndOrg SCP to the Workloads OU.

CLASSIFICATION RULE	Prod and Non-Prod should be based on data sensitivity and risk, not convenience. If an account touches production data, it should be treated as production even when used for development or testing.
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Governance Map

Trusted access	AWS Account Management	Allows organization-level management of account metadata and contact settings.
Billing contact	Management account	Routes billing-related AWS communications to the intended owner.
Operations contact	Management account	Routes operational notices such as service deprecations or health-related communications.
Security contact	Management account	Routes security notifications to the intended security owner.
Prod OU	Workloads	Creates a future boundary for accounts that use or access production data.
Non-Prod OU	Workloads	Creates a development/test boundary with different risk assumptions.
TestAccount1	Non-Prod	Provides a safe initial workload account for testing controls.
ProtectRootAndOrg	Workloads OU	Extends root-protection guardrails to workload accounts.

Evidence

Figure 2 - Management Account Alternate Contacts Configured

Alternate contacts

You can add alternate contacts for Billing, Operations, and Security communications to ensure the correct people are notified for each topic. As a primary account holder, you will continue to receive all email communications. [Learn more](#)

Billing contact

Full name
Michael Salazar

Title
CEO

Operations contact

Full name
Michael Salazar

Title
CEO

Security contact

Full name
Michael Salazar

Title
CEO

The alternate contacts evidence shows Billing, Operations, and Security contact sections populated for the management account. The contact entries show Michael Salazar as the named contact for each category.

Figure 3 - Workloads OU with Non-Prod, Prod, and TestAccount1



The redacted AWS Organizations evidence shows the Workloads OU expanded with Non-Prod and Prod OUs. Non-Prod is expanded and contains TestAccount1, created 2026/07/14. Sensitive identifiers were redacted before publication.

Evidence Limitations

The provided evidence confirms the alternate contacts and the Workloads -> Non-Prod -> TestAccount1 placement.

The trusted access enablement and ProtectRootAndOrg Workloads attachment are documented from the implementation summary supplied by the user and supported by the lab guide workflow, but the uploaded evidence does not include a separate screenshot of those final screens.

The screenshot shows Non-Prod with a hyphen. The lab guide uses NonProd without a hyphen. The project records the actual visible OU name from the user's evidence as Non-Prod.

Security Analysis

Alternate contacts reduce operational risk by separating billing, operations, and security communications instead of relying only on the root email address.

The Workloads hierarchy creates a policy boundary where application accounts can be organized by risk. This is required before applying different SCP baselines for production and non-production workloads.

Moving TestAccount1 into Non-Prod establishes a controlled environment for testing workloads and guardrails without treating the account as production.

Attaching ProtectRootAndOrg to Workloads extends inherited root-principal restrictions to workload accounts. This preserves the root-protection pattern while allowing OU-specific targeting.

Production environments should use distribution lists or group-managed contacts instead of a single person's contact details when multiple teams own billing, operations, and security responsibilities.

Lessons Learned

Trusted access must be enabled for some AWS Organizations integrations before organization-level account management features can be used.

Alternate contacts are governance metadata, but they are operationally important because AWS uses them for account-specific communication.

Prod and Non-Prod are security classifications. The placement should follow the data and risk profile of the account.

OUs provide the structure needed to apply SCPs, account assignments, and governance processes consistently across groups of accounts.

Production Improvements

- Use shared distribution lists for billing, operations, and security contacts instead of individual personal addresses.
- Apply alternate contacts consistently to all accounts through automation.
- Define formal criteria for when an account belongs in Prod versus Non-Prod.
- Create separate baseline SCPs for Prod and Non-Prod after testing them in a safe OU.
- Tag accounts with owner, environment, cost center, data classification, and lifecycle status.
- Validate that ProtectRootAndOrg inheritance behaves as intended for TestAccount1 before adding additional workload accounts.

Skills Demonstrated

AWS Organizations	Trusted access	AWS Account Management
Alternate contacts	OU hierarchy design	Workload segmentation
Prod/Non-Prod design	Account movement	SCP inheritance planning

Resume Bullet

RESUME	Configured AWS Organizations account governance by enabling AWS Account Management trusted access, setting management-account alternate contacts, building Prod and Non-Prod Workloads OUs, creating and placing TestAccount1 in Non-Prod, and attaching root-protection SCP guardrails to Workloads.
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STAR Interview Story

Situation: The AWS organization had security accounts and centralized logging, but needed workload account boundaries and reliable AWS contact routing before adding application accounts.

Task: Configure management-account alternate contacts, build the Workloads Prod/Non-Prod structure, create a test workload account, and apply inherited root-protection guardrails.

Action: I enabled AWS Account Management trusted access, set Billing, Operations, and Security alternate contacts, created Prod and Non-Prod under Workloads, created TestAccount1, moved it into Non-Prod, and attached ProtectRootAndOrg to Workloads.

Result: The environment now has better account contact routing, a usable Workloads hierarchy, a Non-Prod test account, and inherited root-protection controls ready for future workload labs.

Version History

v1.0.0	July 14, 2026	Initial documented implementation. Enabled trusted access for AWS Account Management, configured management-account alternate contacts, created Prod and Non-Prod Workloads OUs, created TestAccount1, moved it into Non-Prod, attached ProtectRootAndOrg to Workloads, and embedded provided evidence using portfolio documentation standard v1.0.1.

References

- Cloud Security Lab a Week (S.L.A.W.) - Buttoning up the Org.
- User-provided management account alternate contacts screenshot.
- User-provided Workloads OU, Non-Prod OU, Prod OU, and TestAccount1 screenshot.
- Project 15 - AWS Organizations Enterprise OU Structure.
- Project 17 - RegionLockout Service Control Policy.